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Press Release

Meropa Resources Addresses Employee Welfare Amidst Minergy Coal Contract Challenges

Gaborone, 11 February 2026 – Meropa Resources wishes to clarify recent developments regarding its contractual engagement with Minergy Coal and the subsequent impact on its workforce.

Meropa Resources, a wholly citizen owned company entered into a five-year agreement with Minergy Coal on 14 December 2023 to provide open cast mining contractor services, employing approximately 600 individuals for the project. Despite the partnership's promising start, Minergy Coal experienced persistent difficulties meeting its payment obligations from the outset, with the situation deteriorating significantly by December 2024. Despite the financial challenges, Meropa Resources was compelled to utilise bank facilities to ensure year-end salary payments for employees. Meropa Resources delivered the Minergy Coal project with executional excellence and mobilised mining equipment in record time achieving 125 000 tonnes of Run of Mine (ROM) with Mine Operations sales trending positively thereafter. Meropa Resources fleet achieved the target available above 80% across key equipment classes reflecting solid maintenance and planning discipline.

Given the mounting operational costs and continued non-payment by Minergy, Meropa Resources formally notified Minergy Coal on 11 February 2025 of its intention to suspend operations. In response, Minergy Coal urged the company to prioritise job preservation. Meropa Resources immediately engaged with the Botswana Mine Workers Union (BMWU), which offered to support efforts to secure outstanding payments. Despite these endeavours, payments remained outstanding.

Between April and July 2025, Meropa Resources was unable to remunerate its employees due to the absence of funds from Minergy Coal. This challenge was openly communicated to the BMWU, who encouraged the company to avoid furloughs and maintain employment, even as prospects of payment diminished.

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Throughout 2025, Meropa Resources and the BMWU held several joint meetings to consider potential solutions, including retrenchment under Section 25 of the Employment Act. At a meeting on 13 June 2025, attended by government representatives and employees, Meropa Resources was requested to issue retrenchment letters.

A resolution was reached at a multi-stakeholder meeting on 12 August 2025 involving government officials, Minergy Coal, and Meropa Resources. It was agreed that outstanding salaries for April–July 2025 would be advanced by MDCB and paid via Khupe Attorneys. Employees were to receive retrenchment letters and undergo exit medical examinations in accordance with Section 91 of the Mines, Quarries and Machinery Act Regulations.

On 19 August 2025, the Minister of Minerals confirmed that the four months' salaries would be paid and later recovered from Meropa Resources once Minergy Coal settled its debt to Meropa. The Ministry further clarified that terminal benefits would be negotiated directly between employees and Meropa Resources.

Following extensive consultations, Meropa Resources formally notified the Commissioner of Labour on 25 August 2025 of redundancy and possible retrenchment on financial grounds, in compliance with Section 25(2) of the Employment Act. Employees were informed that their last day of employment would be 31 August 2025, as the company could not indefinitely retain staff without ongoing work or income.

In January 2026, Meropa Resources announced to the Union its successful appointment on a new contract at Khoemacau Copper Mine, with the intention to re-employ the majority of affected workers. However, BMWU instructed its members not to undertake the required exit medical examinations. Meropa Resources cautioned that this could adversely affect future employment opportunities for staff.

A subsequent meeting between BMWU and Meropa Resources on 27 January 2026 focused on terminal benefits and exit medicals. Meropa Resources proposed a three-month severance package, which was rejected by BMWU, resulting in a formal dispute. This matter is scheduled for a hearing on 4 March 2026 before the Commissioner of Labour which will determine the final outcome regarding terminal benefits and indeed the termination of the employees' employment of

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the 31st August 2025. Meropa Resources will uphold and comply with the outcomes pronounced by the Courts.

To date, Meropa has not been paid all its outstanding invoices.

Meropa Resources reiterates that its actions have been guided by a commitment to employee welfare in the face of sustained non-payment from Minergy Coal. The company has engaged the Union and government authorities at every stage, adhered to legal requirements, facilitated the payment of outstanding salaries, and is actively seeking to re-employ affected workers under a new contract a position less favoured by the BMWU Executive.

In addition to the aforesaid, it is important to further clarify that Meropa Resources, whilst retained for work at Khoemacau Copper Mines, is not a contractor of Khoemacau Copper Mines; it is a subcontractor to one of the contractors to the mine and to further reiterate that the current impasse between Meropa Resources and BMWU has no linkage to Khoemacau Copper Mines which the Union has mischievously and desperately tried to draw a parallel to. Meropa Resources known for its executorial excellence, is at the peak of Equipment mobilisation for the Khoemacau Copper Mines which it will deliver in record time as it aims to replicate the same at the new project. For the record, it should be known that Meropa Resources in all its operations, recorded a Total Recordable Injury Frequency Rate (TRIFR) of 0.00 And Lost Time Injury Frequency Rate (LTIFR) of 0.00.

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